DRILL 14

FORCIBLE ENTRY

NFPA 1001 Level 1 (JPR 4.3.4) / WorkSafeNB Reg 91-191

CONVENTIONAL FORCIBLE ENTRY ("THE IRONS")

⏱ **Time:** 45–60 min | 🚒 **Apparatus:** Any Engine/Truck | 🦺 **PPE:** Full Structural Turnout Gear, Eye Protection & Gloves

👥 **Roles:** Drill Leader (Facilitator) | Safety Officer (Watcher) | Halligan Firefighter & Axe/Striking Firefighter

🎯 OBJECTIVE & RURAL FIREGROUND VALUE

Every firefighter must be able to perform conventional forcible entry on residential and commercial doors using **"The Irons"** (Flathead Axe and Halligan Bar). The two-firefighter team must size up the door, determine swing direction, execute the 3-step sequence (**Gap, Set, Force**), and maintain door control. In rural areas, rapid entry without destroying unnecessary property saves minutes when seconds count.

📦 TOOLS & APPARATUS SETUP

- Forcible entry training door prop (or pallet/scrap 2x4 door simulator).
- 1 set of "The Irons" (8-lb or 6-lb flathead axe and 30-inch Halligan bar).
- Wooden door wedges / chocks.
- Eye protection (safety glasses mandatory under helmet visors).

⚠️ SAFETY WATCH-OUTS & STOP RULE

⚠️ **Flying Debris & Glancing Blows:** The striking firefighter must swing the flathead axe with short, controlled, perpendicular strikes onto the Halligan strike plate. No wild baseball swings!

⚠️ **Hand Placement:** The Halligan firefighter must keep their hands wrapped around the shaft or fork—never curled over the strike plate or between the tool and door frame!

🛑 **THE STOP RULE: Shout "STOP!" immediately if the axe head glances off the Halligan, if hands stray into the strike zone, or if the door pops unexpectedly.**

PHASE 1: SIZE-UP & "TRY BEFORE YOU PRY" (10 MINUTES) — SLOW DRY RUN

1. **The Cardinal Rule: TRY BEFORE YOU PRY!** Rotate the knob and push/pull. You look foolish forcing an unlocked door!
2. **Door Construction & Swing Direction:**
   - **Hinges Visible:** Door swings **OUTWARD** toward you (common in commercial buildings, exterior storage rooms).
   - **No Hinges Visible (Frame Stop Visible):** Door swings **INWARD** away from you (standard residential front/rear doors).
3. **Check for Locks:** Look for deadbolts, rim locks, keyways, and feel door resistance with the halligan adz.

PHASE 2: INWARD-SWINGING DOOR (GAP, SET, FORCE) (20 MINUTES) — BUDDY COACHING

1. **GAP:**
   - Place the bevel of the Halligan **fork** (or adz) against the door edge, 6 inches above or below the lock cylinder.
   - Push the tool into the door stop to create an initial purchase gap between the door and the jamb.
2. **SET:**
   - Halligan firefighter works the fork into the gap, wrapping the curve around the door edge.
   - Halligan firefighter directs the striking firefighter with clear, single-word commands:
   - *"HIT!"* = One crisp, controlled strike on the adz/strike plate.
   - *"HIT!"* = Second strike driving the fork deeper.
   - *"STOP!"* = Cease striking immediately.
   - The fork is "set" when the arch of the fork straddles the inner door jamb.
3. **FORCE:**
   - Halligan firefighter pushes the Halligan bar hard toward the door face (using maximum mechanical leverage).
   - The lock bolt pops past the strike plate, and the door swings inward.
   - **Door Control:** Immediately slip a boot or the axe handle against the door to keep it from swinging wide open and feeding fresh oxygen to an interior fire!

PHASE 3: OUTWARD-SWINGING DOOR (15 MINUTES) — TIMED / STRESS

1. Outward swinging doors are the easiest and fastest to force.
2. Insert the **adz end** of the Halligan between the door and the frame near the lock.
3. Command: *"HIT!"* to drive the adz deep behind the door stop.
4. Push the shaft of the Halligan firmly outward (away from the building). The door pops open toward you instantly.

⚠️ COMMON PITFALLS & FIREGROUND HAZARDS

- ✗ *Curling fingers over the Halligan adz:* When the axe strikes, a missed blow or vibration will crush fingers. Keep hands strictly on the center knurling of the Halligan bar.
- ✗ *Swinging the axe like a sledgehammer:* Huge, wide swings miss the target and risk hitting your partner. Short, powerful, 12-to-18-inch strikes from the shoulder offer 10x more control.
- ✗ *Losing door control after the pop:* If you pop the door and let it blow open, modern fire dynamics show flow path acceleration can cause a flashover within 60–90 seconds! Chock or control the door.

🗣️ 5-MINUTE TAILGATE DEBRIEF

1. ***"Were the 'HIT' and 'STOP' verbal commands crisp and loud?", "Did the Halligan firefighter keep their hands out of the strike path?"***

✅ APPARATUS RESET CHECKLIST

- ☐ Axe blade inspected for chips or burrs; file smooth if needed.
- ☐ Halligan fork and adz checked for bends or cracks.
- ☐ Married together using standard strap or friction fit and returned to apparatus bracket.
- ☐ Attendance roster signed.

DRILL LEADER SIGNATURE	SAFETY OFFICER SIGNATURE	DATE COMPLETED	TRAINING HOURS